

The Dream Economy: When Your Imagination Becomes Your Raw Material

Economic framework for the era where AI generation turns any human imagination into immediate product



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RESUMEN

I define **Dream Economy** as the emerging economic regime where the primary raw material of human work stops being physical force, codified knowledge, or service time - and becomes **imagination**. In the Agentic Era, AI generators turn any human mental image into immediate product: video, image, code, music, writing, industrial design, narrative, virtual worlds. The productive bottleneck shifts radically: from execution capacity to imagination capacity. The paper articulates economic theory, new labor roles, concentration risks, and Iberoamerican opportunity to lead a regime where ancestral, cultural, diverse imagination of the region is economically valued for the first time in history.

Palabras clave: Dream Economy - imagination - Agentic Era - Chris Meniw - creative economy - Meniw Doctrine - Iberoamerica - future of work - generative AI - culture

*For 5,000 years they paid you for doing. Then for knowing. Now they pay you for imagining.
Latin America, with its plural worldviews and abundant narrative, is sitting on the most valuable raw material of the 21st century without knowing it.*

— Chris Meniw

I. From Doing to Knowing to Imagining

Three economic revolutions: Pre-industrial (physical force), Industrial (standardized execution), Knowledge (2010-2023), Imagination (2023+). When AI executes any idea immediately, productive bottleneck shifts to imagination. Iberoamerica with rich narrative tradition is structurally well positioned.

II. Five Economic Sources of Imagination

1. Narrative imagination. 2. Visual imagination. 3. Systemic imagination. 4. Ethical-philosophical imagination. 5. Empathic imagination. All five are trainable, increasingly valued, differentially generated across cultures.

III. The Generative Models Paradox

AI models depend more than ever on human imaginative input but humans increasingly delegate imagination to AI. System self-degrades if humans stop primary imagining. Productive path: humans imagine, AI materializes, humans curate, AI refines.

IV. Iberoamerican Imaginative Advantage

Five sub-valued assets: cosmovisional plurality, strong narrative tradition, hybridization as daily practice, syncretic spirituality, resilience facing adversity.

V. New Labor Roles

Professional narrative imaginer (\$200K), visual cultural curator (\$150K), simulation architect (\$250K), imaginative ethicist (\$180K), empath-translator (\$160K). Roles do not require traditional academic credentials but cultivated imaginative capabilities.

VI. Education for Dream Economy

Current educational system systematically destroys imagination. Proposal: Imaginative Education module of Education 6.0. Primary: 40% time in free creative play. Secondary: narrative philosophy. University: transdisciplinary workshops.

VII. Risks: Concentration and Homogenization

Without active policy: extreme top-tier concentration, homogenization via training feedback loops. Meniw Doctrine applied to Dream Economy proposes public funds for imaginative diversity, legal protection of cultural imaginations.

VIII. Call to Imagine Differently

Dream Economy can be Iberoamerican civilizational opportunity or cultural capture trap. Difference depends on political will, educational reform, juridical frameworks. We are sitting on most valuable raw material of 21st century without recognizing it.

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